How to mix the colour and its shades

In painting, orange is made by mixing yellow and red. **The result, though, depends on the specific colours.** Two different reds with the same yellow can give quite different mixes. A warmer red close to orange is usually easier for a bright mix than a red with a distinctly pink or violet tint. The proportions are approximate, every brand behaves a little differently, so try them out on paper first.

What to prepare



Yellow
Gives a lighter, yellower version of orange.



Red
Pushes it towards vermilion, stronger and redder.



White
Lightens it and creates apricot and peach tones.



Brown
Helps with autumn and earthy shades.



Ochre
Gentler earthy tones, good for pumpkin and clay orange.



Blue
Its opposite on the colour wheel; in a truly small amount it mutes orange.

How can you recognise it without technical names?

A yellower orange may recall a mandarin or a sea buckthorn berry, a redder one a ripe orange or a pumpkin. Names on tubes differ between makers, so put **small samples** side by side and **add white** to part of them. The tint will then show better.

On the tube look for the mark **PO** (Pigment Orange) and a number. It tells you which pigment it is even when the name differs.

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What the additions do



White

Lightens it and shifts it towards apricot and peach. Add it a little at a time.





Yellow

Leads to sunny, mandarin tones.





Red

Leads to vermilion and red-orange. A strong pigment, add it carefully.





Brown

Earthy, autumn tones. Terracotta and rust.





Ochre

Gentler earthy and clay tones, pumpkin.





Blue

Mutes it; a larger dose pulls it towards brown or grey-brown.



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Ten oranges to try

A part can be a drop or an equally large heap of paint. **Take the proportions as a starting point for experimenting**, not as a recipe for a Christmas loaf.

Basic orange



2 parts yellow + 1 part red. Balanced, full of energy.

Yellow-orange



4 parts yellow + 1 part red. Sunny, light, mandarin.

Red-orange



1 part yellow + 2 parts red. Rich, hot, bold. Already approaching red.

Light apricot



1 part orange + 2 parts white, possibly a drop of yellow. Soft and kind. Add the white gradually.

Peach



1 part orange + 4 to 5 parts white, and depending on the result a tiny bit of red. Tender, quiet, warming.

Salmon



4 parts white + 1 part red + roughly half a part yellow. Softly pink, with a light touch of orange.

Pumpkin



2 parts yellow + 1 part red + a tiny trace of ochre. A more earthy form of orange, autumnal.

Terracotta



3 parts orange + 1 part brown; adjust the lightness with white. Earthy, firm, warm.

Muted rust



3 parts red-orange + 1 part brown, possibly a trace of blue. Deep, autumnal.

Soft dusty orange



2 parts orange + 2 parts white + blue on the tip of the brush (roughly 1 part to 20 parts orange). Veiled, soft, a little retro.

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